

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter 
in association with

COASTAL DEBRIS

We are all perhaps far too familiar with debris found strewn across our coasts. Whilst some is from far flung places, much can be traced back to more local sources. We all have our part to play, especially in preventing rubbish from getting into the local environment in the first place. Work is also ongoing through many means, to tackle the increasing problems of marine debris, in particular that from the fishing industry.

Recently, Scotlands' salmon farmers have released this helpful email address for the public to contact regarding marine litter that they find: reportdebris@salmonscotland.co.uk

Reports should ideally contain a what3words exact location and photo. The information will be collated centrally and reported to local teams for recovery. The litter does not have to have originated from a fish farm.

You can also help by picking up debris and litter, if safe to do so, and disposing of it responsibly. Together we can help this situation, and hopefully in turn prevent some of the many marine deaths that are caused by such debris each year.

LONELINESS

Loneliness has no common cause and there are different types of loneliness.

Some loneliness is situational, where we might have moved to a new place, or live somewhere where we don't have the right level of connection. Loneliness can be linked to a specific life event, like a bereavement, a relationship breakdown, becoming a new parent, or stress at work. Emotional loneliness can happen in relationships and families, where you have people in your life but you don't feel close to or understood by them.

There is no "one size fits all" to loneliness and more often than not you won't know someone is feeling lonely, unless they say, or you ask. By building on our understanding of loneliness, we can all help each other and ourselves. If you have some spare time, you might like to consider volunteering with Befriending Lewis. Otherwise, if you are finding yourself lonely, you might like to request a befriender.

Get in touch at info@befriendinglewis.org.uk or call **01851 702632**

YOGA CLASSES

Fancy getting a bit more stretch in your life and would like to do Yoga?
Ekki Mukk Spirited Yoga is running weekly Wednesday evening sessions and will be offering early Saturday morning sessions soon.

Join Victoria on Wednesdays at 7:30pm (1 hour class)

Bernera Community Centre Hall

£5 per session (Beginners welcome)

Call **07912 292 816** / or email victoria.evans05@hotmail.co.uk to find out more.



AVIAN FLU

Avian flu has now, sadly, been confirmed in the Western Isles. Great Skua and Gannet appear to be the worst affected currently, but a range of other bird species can be infected. Please avoid contact with dead birds, give sick and dying birds space - Do NOT approach or touch the bird, keep dogs on leads and report all such instances to the DEFRA helpline (**03459 335577**).

The RSPB and Nature Scot are working together to collate all records of birds with suspected avian influenza on the islands. If you see a suspected case please email a record to **robyn.stewart@rspb.org.uk** including date, species (if known) and location.

SEALS

As we approach summer and our coastlines get busier with humans and our activities, please spare a thought for our wildlife that we share the marine environment with.

The number of incidents involving people disturbing wildlife has increased dramatically nationwide in recent years, particularly involving seals as they haul out on land to sleep, give birth to their pups, and conserve energy.

Seals are especially wary of threats when on land, and can easily be scared off into the sea when people get too close or are too noisy. Seals who feel particularly threatened will rush into the sea where they are much faster and able to escape, but in the process can fall down rock faces and seriously injure themselves in their panic. It can also separate mothers and pups, who will starve to death if she has been scared off completely.

A coalition called the Seal Alliance, which formed in response to the growing problem of disturbance, has created a Government backed code of conduct. By following this advice we can all play our part in minimising our impact, whilst still being able to watch the wildlife on our shores.

DO KEEP:

WELL AWAY - use your cameras or binoculars
QUIET - so seals can't hear us
DOWNWARD - so seals can't smell us
OUT OF SIGHT - so seals can't see us
DOGS - under control on leads
LITTER - take it home

NEVER:

Get close to seals
 Fly drones near seals
 Feed wild seals
 Scare seals or put pups into the sea
 Copy the bad behaviour of others
 Take a seal selfie

SEAS OF THE OUTER HEBRIDES

Seas of the Outer Hebrides aims to improve outcomes for both people and nature across the islands. By directly involving communities in the monitoring and management of our Marine Protected Areas, they hope to get a broader understanding of our marine environment and better decision making on how our seas are used in the future.

Over the last 3 years they have engaged all over the Outer Hebrides about what is needed to protect the marine environment and our communities. They are now putting a community led Vision, 4 objectives and 10 linked recommendations for MPAs (Marine Protected Areas) management to public consultation. Everyone's views count. Join the growing number of community voices and have your say here, bit.ly/seasconsult. MPA's are sites that are designated to protect our nationally and Internationally important natural habitats, plants and animals. In Scotland sites designated as MPAs are intended to support sustainable use. For more information about the project, or to take part in the survey in another format contact **charlie.main@uhi.ac.uk**

POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS - GARDENING WOES



Gardening in June so far has been more than difficult. We did have some good weather for about ten days at the very beginning, encouraging not only us to get out there and do something, but the plants to grow and flower. Then in comes the June gale to blast off all our efforts. It's so difficult at these times not to get discouraged. Shelter is the key, either by Netting between posts soundly hammered in, or trees, even dead twigs will break the wind. Solid structures tend to create wind eddies, which in turn destroy your efforts.

Anything will do as a barrier, bits of plank hammered into the ground where you want shelter so long as you don't make a solid barrier. Even old crab pots loosely filled with stones. You are aiming not to stop the wind but to break it.

With the help of Alan, my now second in command, we finished more or less one vegetable bed, so I could get my little brassicas out into this wind and though they take time to get established they are still growing. Next week I must earth up my Potatoes, a job for the younger, fitter, Alan. Even he could not make sense of part of the vegetable plot which now resembles thick chocolate pudding, totally undiggable.

Everything which is in shelter including my fruit trees in my Keder Greenhouse are surviving well and coming along nicely. But fruit outside in the wind, like the poor gooseberries, not quite ripe yet, are being blown off for the starlings to eat. The cut worm has already decimated my three bushes, which I refuse to spray as it kills my precious bees. Strawberries seem to be hanging on, as do Black currants. But it has all become a bit of a struggle this month. So, here's a tiny heart warming story for you all. One of my hens went broody, and despite sitting on one real egg and two wooden eggs, hatched out one black chick. I shooed them both into a pen for individual nurturing, three weeks later while feeding said hen flew over my head out into the fresh air leaving her chick. This chick now resides in the barn being looked after, not by its mum, but by a large red fluffy Rooster. I've never seen this behaviour before, but they are indeed a couple, dad and daughter perhaps, dad and son more likely.

Keep plugging away gardeners, this wind will stop eventually and we can all get on.

Penny Spinks
Hacklete



CONNECT FOUR QUIZ

What word or thing connects these words

1. Drunk – Bag – Up – Ball
2. Political – Birthday – Surprise – Dinner
3. Band – Stamp – Plant – Ball
4. Irish – Scots – Welsh – Coldstream
5. Yangtze – Nith – Mississippi – Avon
6. Weddell – Black – Hebridean – South China
7. Phone – Photo – Kissing – Lottery
8. Tongue – Throat – Heel – Toe
9. Greek – Maltese – Celtic – Canterbury
10. Fingernail – Shoe – Performance – Tooth
11. Leather – Cord – Denim – Cotton
12. Chain – fathom – furlong – cubit
13. Mousetrap – Wicked – Pygmalion – Macbeth
14. Kiss – Raspberry – Fuse – Egg
15. Pawpaw – Loganberry – Kiwi – Tomato
16. Dover- Sole – Fisher – Viking
17. Zeus – Jupiter – Odin – Osiris
18. SG1 – Babylon 5 – Blakes 7 – Farscape
19. Hornsea – Denby – Poole – Arran
20. Argon – Helium – Neon – Krypton
21. Seafield – Broomhouse – Robroyston – Longannet
22. Bell – Watt – Mcadam – 23. Mackintosh
23. Windsor – Stirling – Harlech – Carrickfergus
24. Windsor – Simple – Bow – Prince Albert
25. Golf – Viva – Punto – Capri
26. Belfast – Ocean – Repulse – Victory
27. Butlers – Breakfast – Tea – Dinner
28. Java – Mocha – Blue Mountain – Kona
29. Medicine – Base – Beach – Foot
30. Vanity – Goose – Summer – Book

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



ANNS ABHLIADHNA NAOI CEUD DEUG, DÀ FHICHEAD 'TRÌ DEUG



Thòisich mi san sgoil à d saor-laithean na Cà, nuair a bha mi faisg air c bliadhna a dhaois. Bha a' bhun-sgoil sin fad air falbh bhon taigh againn agus bfheudar dhomh coiseachd d mh gu taigh eile far an robh sinn a faighinn lioft dhan sgoil. Cha robh mi ann ach beagan mh gus an do dhimrich an teaghlach gu baile eile. Chan eil m chuimhneachain sona agam air na c laithean - sgoile, oir chuir na caileagan bu shine an t - eagal m oirnn gu tric. Bhitheadh iad atarraing asa, gar glasadh anns na taighean - beaga. Uaireannan chluicheadh iad air fiacairean agus sinne na h-euslaintich. Bha e acrdadh e riutha ar fiacian a bhrodadh le droigheann fada. bha aon rud bu mhiosa dhomhsa: Thuirt iad gur e bana - bhuidseach a bh' anns an tidsear againn agus bha sinne gan creidsinn. Bha leabhar agam aig an taigh le dealbh de bhana bhuidseach ann. Bha dreasa dhubh is beannag dhubh oirre is fuì mh air a sr.

Nuair a choimhead mi air an tidsear bha mi asmao air abhana - bhu bhon leabhar oir bha ise seann - fhasanta le g fada dubh is bonaid purpaidh oirre.

Bha mi air mo dh glan nuair a chaidh mi dhan sgoil ù. An sin bha a h - uile duine coibhneil agus cuideachail. Ged nach robh mi gl thoilichte anns achiad bhun - sgoil, tha cuimhne agam air aon thachartas cudromach: Cr na Banr. Bha na sgoilearan uile trang ag ullachadh rudan eadar - dhealaichte airson an latha s ud. Rinn sinn a h-uile se sgeadachadh, mar fleasgan, lanntairean neo basgaidean, acleachdadh nan dathan gorm, geal is dearg.

Ach bha t obair aig na tidsearan, acruithachadh cr do gach leanabh agus bha ar m gl thrang cuideachd. fhuaigheal mo mh sgiort is seacaid gorma dhomhsa agus dhfighe i geansaidh geal le p dearg. Air Latha aChr fh bha p m anns an talla agus th na sgoilear an gu l le aodach agus crin ghorm, gheal is dearg orra.

Chan fhaca sinn aBhanr idir oir cha robh telebhisean ann.

Ach bha cothrom agam a faicinn beagan bhliadhnaichean air ais nuair a thadhail i air Lockerbie. latha sg is frasach a bh' ann ach bha ache air beulaibh Talla aBhaile loma - l. Bha an sgoil againn am measg an t- sluaigh agus bha a h - uile duine asm le brataichean beaga.

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



CROFT 22



Our Forage Croft Honesty Shop at Croft 22 Kirkibost has been open for nearly a year. It has settled into a gentle rhythm, with lovely customers who use it to stock up on everything from cheese, biscuits and milk to bacon, bread and veg. In the past year, we have stocked gooseberries from a croft on Bernera, potatoes from Ranish as well as charcuterie and lamb from the Isle of Lewis.

We've been able to experiment with bringing fresh produce wherever possible from the Hebrides and Scotland to the island, whilst reducing non essential trips to town for our customers.

Tourists are starting to find us and we should finally have a sign going up soon to signpost where we are. There are a range of items, and some treats from Tesco too, after requests from customers. We are also stockists for a range of plastic free, environmentally

friendly products for use at home as well.

To celebrate we are offering a range of deals over the coming months. The summer deal is for **Ecovibe** cleaning kits and beauty products, which we are offering at 40% off rrp. So pop in and see what we have to offer.

If you would like to find out more about the products we stock, or want to sell any of your surplus croft produce feel free to give us a call too. Contact julia@croft22.co.uk - 07894 516609



GREAT BERNERA COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT TRUST

There had been much speculation surrounding the proposed development of a large offshore windfarm between Carloway and Barvas. As such the West Side Estates (which also include the Bernera Trust) have issued a statement to bring some clarity to the situation.

The West Side Estate Group is an informal association of four community-owned Estates and one privately owned Estate on the West Side of Lewis. These Estates, from North to South, are Galson Estate, Barvas Estate, Dalmore Estate (privately owned), Carloway Estate and Great Bernera Community Development Trust (at pre-purchase stage). The West Side Estate Group, and Comhairle nan Eilean Siar have been pro-active in engaging with offshore wind developers who were successful in the recent Scotwind leasing round. The closest areas included in the leasing round are referred to as N2 and N3 which are fairly distant from the islands plus N4 which is located only 5km offshore, broadly between Carloway and Barvas.

Whilst there is no requirement on these developers to engage with neighbouring communities, the proximity of N4 has led the West Side Estate Group and Comhairle nan Eilean Siar to take a pro-active approach to ensure that the communities affected are widely consulted and informed of potential benefits in order to weigh up the pros and cons. The Memorandum of Understanding creates a framework for this engagement although it is not legally binding. Mindful of the climate crisis and energy affordability pressures that are being experienced across the country, the West Side Estate Group recognises the need for initiatives to increase renewable energy generation, but not at any cost.

The option to develop ScotWind Area N4 was awarded by Crown Estate Scotland to Northland Power in January this year. The project is at an early stage and the developer has commenced environmental surveys of the area prior to submitting applications for Marine Licences and Section 36 (Electricity Act) consent in 2024/25. On this timeline, construction of the wind farm, potentially generating 840MW, could take place from 2027 with first electricity produced from 2029. The Memorandum of Understanding does not confirm community support for the development of N4, rather it reflects a determination on the part of community leaders and the Comhairle to keep communities informed and secure maximum benefit from what could be an extremely large renewable energy development. The community will be able to comment on the detail of the project during the consenting phase which is expected in 2024/25.

HOUSING DEMAND SURVEY

Many thanks to all those who submitted feedback for the Housing Demand Survey either online or via the paper form in last month issue of Bernera News. We will keep you informed on progress on any future housing development, and if you haven't yet filled out a form, you can still do so by clicking on the link on the Trust's Facebook posts (Housing Demand Survey), or by requesting a paper form by emailing jo@greatbernera.org / tel: **07771 534048**

BERNERA BIKES



On Saturday the 9th July, at the rather brilliant Bosta Fun day, the GBCDT team of Nat and Jo were out with other volunteers, giving locals and visitors a chance to try out some of the new e-bikes which had just arrived the day before. It was great to see so many having a go and giving us feedback on what they'd use them for and how much they'd be willing to pay, etc.

The bikes are being stored until the storage unit is in place and fully fitted out, near the Kirkibost Pier Pontoon Development, in a couple of weeks. We will be doing a proper launch with booking and prices to be finalised before then.

If you are interested in finding out more or would like to try one out before the launch contact nat@greatbernera.org - **07831 690547**

BERNERA BAKES... GINGER NUT SLICE

Ingredients

250g crushed ginger nut biscuits
3oz condensed milk
3oz butter

Topping

2oz butter
1 tbsp syrup
1 tbsp ground ginger
 $\frac{3}{4}$ cup icing sugar

Instructions

- Prepare a baking tray with greaseproof paper.
- On a low heat melt the butter & condensed milk together in a pan.
- Crush gingernut biscuits.
- Add the ginger nut biscuits to the melted mixture.
- Leave to cool slightly.
- Melt the butter & syrup together in a pan over low heat.
- Beat in ground ginger & icing sugar, mixing well.
- Pour of the prepared slice.
- Leave to set, overnight.
- Cut into slices.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



WHAT IS NECESSARY AND WHAT IS SUPERFLUOUS?

Sometimes situations and events in life arise which require us to reassess what is truly important and what is not.

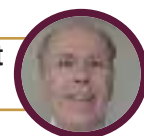
It may be a new relationship, an illness, a child being born, the loss of a loved one or of one's employment. Each distinct event requires us to prioritise and perhaps re-prioritise our plan. In effect, to declutter, or to defrag our lives.

In the fifth century a man named Arenius set out to live as holy a life as he could possibly live. Abandoning all the comforts of Egyptian society, he pursued wholeheartedly an austere lifestyle in the desert. Yet, whenever he visited the great city of Alexandria, he spent time wandering through its bazaars. A seemingly strange occupation, given his monastic ambitions. Asked why, he explained that his heart rejoiced at the sight of all the things he didn't need. Perhaps, we ourselves, who live in a society flooded with goods, gadgets and gizmo's also need to ponder the example of that desert dweller.

A typical Tesco supermarket in the United Kingdom stocks 90,000 different products but how many of these are absolutely essential?

Helpfully, the Bible informs us that, '*..one thing is needful: and Mary has chosen that good part, which shall not be taken away from her*', **Lk 10:40**

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



FIRST REGISTRATION OF A CROFT

Donald John Smith, residing at 30B Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, has registered his croft 19 Valtos, Uig, Isle of Lewis, on the Crofting Register held by the Register of Scotland.

Any person who wishes to challenge the registration may apply to the Scottish Land Court by 6th April 2023.

Details of the registration can be found at www.crofts.ros.gov.uk/register/home. The croft registration number is C8512.